

in response to *The Happiest Thought*,
Agnieszka Polska, 2019

the sound that binds to boundlessness

the clock is in free fall. how much
does a 150 kilo millipede weigh?
on its back, vulnerability sings—redshifted,
waves stretching thinner as i drift away,
wondering how much mass
will be contained within the extinction.

i've heard the ocean is blue. but why
aren't we as confused
as the child when she gazes
upon the perpetual *murmuring*?
instead, our trepidation unravels,
intimacy lost, floating away in the water.

message in a bottle—a map of pangea.
resembling the ancient panacea.
unfolding the scroll reveals that to lift
a millipede is the goal. and when the child,
waiting on shore, asks her mother why
the continents fell apart.
there is no response.